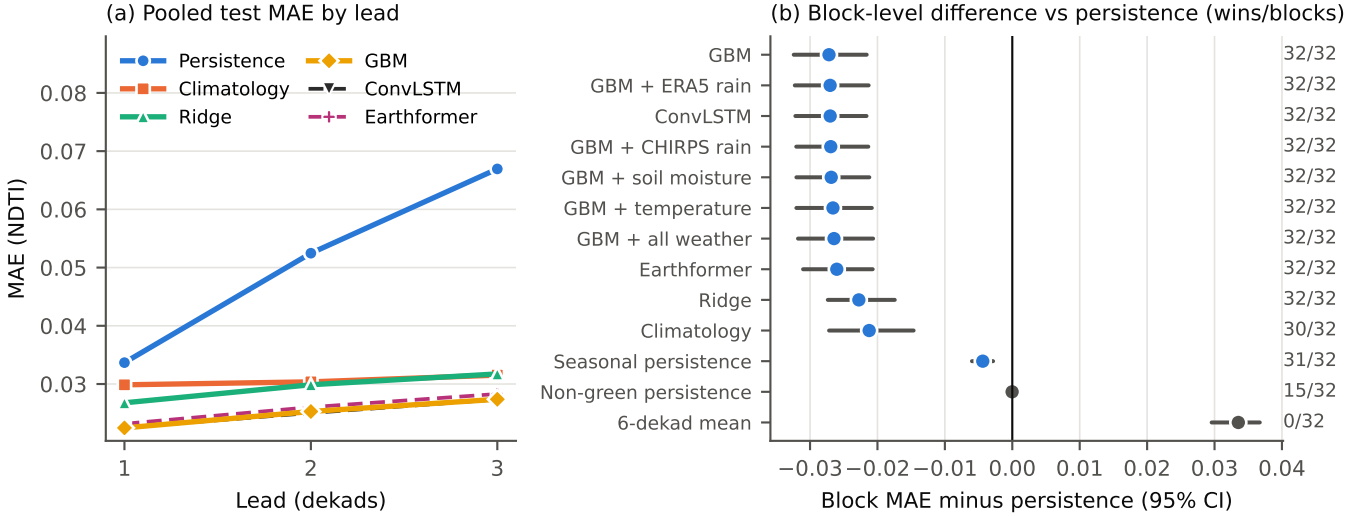
(a) Pooled test MAE by lead
Persistence
Climatology
Ridge
GBM
ConvLSTM
Earthformer
MAE (NDTI)
0.08
0.07
0.06
0.05
0.04
0.03
1
2
3
Lead (dekads)
(b) Block-level difference vs persistence (wins/blocks)
GBM
GBM + ERA5 rain
ConvLSTM
GBM + CHIRPS rain
GBM + soil moisture
GBM + temperature
GBM + all weather
Earthformer
Ridge
Climatology
Seasonal persistence
Non-green persistence
6-dekad mean
32/32
32/32
32/32
32/32
32/32
32/32
32/32
32/32
32/32
30/32
31/32
15/32
0/32
−0.03
−0.02
−0.01
0.00
0.01
0.02
0.03
0.04
Block MAE minus persistence (95% CI)